

Design Brief — Northlake Login & Loading Animations (POC)

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Paste the block below into Claude (design / front-end generation). It produces two Northlake-branded, **per-customer** web animations as a POC: a login entrance animation and a loading animation.

Dependencies: new libraries are allowed **only if MIT or Apache-2.0 licensed**, and the library used must be named with its license. This makes **Lottie** the recommended path — it's the natural per-customer model (ship the player once, swap a JSON per customer).

Rendered deliverable: generated animations live in [documents/brand/animations/](#) — login + loading (Lottie JSON + CSS/SVG), `northlake-theme-vars.css`, and a README. Built on **lottie-web (MIT)**, no GSAP; verified against the `.k-loading-mask / .auth-branding__figure` hooks with reduced-motion fallbacks.

Integration facts (so output drops in):

- App has **no** animation library today; adding one is fine **if MIT/Apache-2.0**.
- App themes via CSS custom properties: `--color-accent`, `--color-primary-2`, `--color-tertiary`, `--color-primary`, `--font-size-sm`.
- Loading today: a Kendo loading mask restyled in `loading-animation.less` — `.k-loading-mask` overlay, `.k-loading-image` (56×56) spinner via `@keyframes app-loading-spin`, optional `.k-loading-text` caption.
- Login hero markup: `.auth-branding > .auth-branding__figure` (img + figcaption), styled by `login/_auth-branding.less`.

You are creating a **proof-of-concept set of two web animations** for Northlake University's EEM Suite portal (fictional). Brand: deep navy #1F3A5F, warm gold #C9A227, slate/teal support tones, white. Motif: "Northlake" = north + lake → **concentric lake ripples + a leaf/energy spark** (tie to the logo's lake/leaf mark). Tone: calm, premium, institutional — subtle, not flashy.

Licensing rule (important)

Any new dependency must be **MIT or Apache-2.0**, and you must state the license you chose. Eligible: **Lottie** (lottie-web or @lottiefles/dotlottie-web) — MIT; `anime.js` — MIT; **Motion One** (motion) — MIT; Rive web runtime — MIT. **Do not use GSAP/GreenSock** (not MIT/Apache). Pure CSS/SVG (no dependency) is also fine.

Recommended approach

- **Primary — Lottie (MIT):** ship `lottie-web/@lottiefiles/dotlottie-web` once; each customer is just a different `.json/.lottie` file. Use it for the rich login entrance. Deliver the player integration + a **working sample Lottie JSON** for Northlake (hand-authored simple shape animation is fine for the POC), and note that production JSONs would come from a designer (After Effects/LottieFiles).
- **Alternative — anime.js or Motion One (MIT)** animating inline SVG, if you'd rather hand-author the motion as code for the POC.
- **Loading spinner:** a small **CSS/SVG** loop is fine here (zero-dep, lives in the Kendo mask); offer a Lottie version too for a richer full-page splash.
- Always include a `prefers-reduced-motion`: reduce static fallback.

Per-customer model

Whatever you choose, make reskinning a customer trivial: **Lottie** → swap the JSON (+ theme colors); **CSS/SVG** → change the `--color-*` custom properties and swap the SVG mark. Northlake values: `--color-primary-2:#1F3A5F` (navy), `--color-accent:#C9A227` (gold), a teal `--color-tertiary`.

Performance & quality

Prefer transform/opacity motion; 60fps; seamless loops; keep payloads modest (Lottie player + JSON, or a small CSS/SVG block). Email-/browser-safe, accessible.

Deliverable 1 — Login entrance animation (targets `.auth-branding__figure`)

The Northlake mark **assembles** (lake ripples expand; a gold leaf/energy spark settles), then the wordmark fades/slides up and a **gold underline draws** under the title. ~1.8–2.5s; optional subtle ambient ripple after. Layers over a soft navy gradient panel; must not block the form. Lottie recommended.

Deliverable 2 — Loading animation (overrides `.k-loading-mask` `.k-loading-image`, 56×56)

Replace the generic ring with a Northlake loader — concentric lake ripples pulsing outward from the leaf/energy mark (or the mark gently pulsing). Keep the `.k-loading-text` hook. ~1.0–1.4s seamless loop; readable on the translucent blurred mask. CSS/SVG is fine here; also provide a Lottie version for a full-page splash.

Output

Write to `documents/brand/animations/`:

- `login-animation.html` — standalone preview + the integration (Lottie player init **or** CSS/SVG) targeting `.auth-branding__figure`.
- `loading-animation.html` — standalone preview + the drop-in LESS overriding `.k-loading-mask` `.k-loading-image` (supersedes `loading-animation.less`), plus a Lottie splash variant.
- `northlake-login.json` / `northlake-loading.json` — Lottie sources if used.
- `northlake-theme-vars.css` — the CSS custom-property override block.

- README.md — files + where they go, **the library and its license**, reduced-motion behavior, and a "reskin for another customer" recipe (swap JSON or vars + mark).

Keep it production-credible: clean, accessible, license-compliant (MIT/Apache only), and clearly per-customer.
